

► DISTINGUISHED FLYING CROSS

Date 1918

Origin UK

Introduced for officers of the British Royal Air Force, the Distinguished Flying Cross (DFC) was awarded for acts of valour. World War I saw approximately 1,100 DFCs issued, while 20,354 were awarded during World War II. The DFC was opened to all ranks in 1993.



Propeller design on vertical arms



Golden background rays denote a 1st Class award

T-35 tank depicted on front

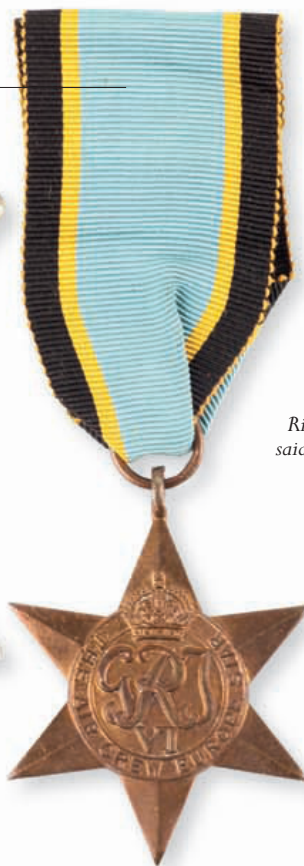
▲ MEDAL FOR COURAGE

Date 1938

Origin Soviet Union

First introduced to recognize displays of courage in battle by military personnel in the defence of the Soviet Union, this medal continued to be awarded by Russia after the break-up of the USSR. Its recipients receive a monthly pension and travel free on Russian public transport.

Black, yellow, and blue stripes represent night flying, enemy searchlights, and the sky



▲ AIR CREW EUROPE STAR

Date 1945

Origin UK

Conflict World War II

The rarest World War II campaign star, this medal was awarded for operations over Europe from UK bases from 3 September 1939 to 5 June 1944. The recipient had to hold the 1939–45 Star and have flown in operations for two months between these dates.

▼ PURPLE HEART

Date 1782

Origin US

The original Purple Heart was instituted by George Washington in 1782 as the Badge of Military Merit, and was issued only to three Revolutionary War soldiers. The award was not proposed again until 1932. Approximately 1.9 million Purple Hearts have been issued since that date.



Ribbon colours said to represent blood, snow, and death

◀ EASTERN FRONT MEDAL

Date 1942

Origin Germany

Conflict World War II

Commonly known as the "Ostmedaille", this award marked service on the Eastern Front between 15 November 1941 and 15 April 1942. In reference to the hardship endured during that winter campaign, it was nicknamed the "Gefrierfleischorden" (Frozen Meat Medal).



Eagle and swastika motif